# Mark Davis

Effective type is my design mission: typefaces for brands and products, from one-style logotypes to open-source variable families.

Type designer and font engineer. Studied at Type@Cooper, then moved from the Midwest to Brooklyn to start at Font Bureau under Roger Black.

## Experience

**WORDMARK** 2017–Present
Founder, Type Designer & Art Director · Brooklyn, New York

- **Vercel:** Geist Serif. Took over the drawings for Vercel's first serif, expanded the glyph set, built the variable axis and kerned it. Released Oct 30, 2026 as the fourth Geist family.
- **Cal.com:** Cal Sans, Cal Sans UI, Text & Geo. Open-source 8-master, 6-axis variable family, ~1,000 glyphs, 3,000 kerns; 1.9M Google Fonts deliveries a week. Creative Boom best new typeface, April 2026.
- **Harvey:** expanding Harvey Serif, the brand's custom display serif.
- **WELTKERN Type:** type design and engineering retainer, custom commissions.
- **Pentagram:** custom brand serif with Margot Lévêque. Mastering, custom glyphs, swash ligatures, stylistic sets and PUA encoding.
- **NYMZO:** logotype for the luxury chess challenger brand, taken to global launch and product readiness (with Otherward).
- **National Museum of Women in the Arts & VNS Health:** agency-of-record art direction across HTML5 display, OOH, digital OOH and wild postings (with Tronvig). Creative lead on a wayfinding and donor signage program, including the new building front sign and lettering.
- **Kentucky Derby, Ticketmaster, SUNY Geneseo & UND:** branding and advertising, sole designer on select accounts (with SME Branding).

**NBCUniversal** 2017
Creative Agency Freelance Designer · New York

- Created new internal brands for NBCU across many formats and collateral.

**BuzzFeed News** 2016
Freelance Designer · New York

- Designed news section templates and spot illustrations.
- Designed the Trump "BF Tiny Hand" font, which went viral.

**The Font Bureau, Inc.** 2015–2016
Font Intern, Design & Marketing Contractor · Brooklyn

- Created specimens for retail typefaces and social and newsletter graphics; developed typefaces under Roger Black.

## Teaching

Rhode Island School of Design 2023

School of Visual Arts 2022

Queens College 2022

The Futur, live interview 2020
70K+ views

"Fonts You Should Know" 2021
The Futur, 80K+ views

## Education

**The Cooper Union** 2015
Type@Cooper Condensed
Critiqued by Christian Schwartz and Tobias Frere-Jones; guest critique by Jonathan Hoefler

**Taylor University** 2014
BA Art, Graphic Design
Designer of the Year

## Recognition

Creative Boom 2026
Best new typefaces of April: Cal Sans UI

Abduzeedo 2026
Feature: Cal Sans UI

## Tools

Glyphs 3, RoboFont, Python & fontTools, variable fonts, OpenType features, Figma, Framer, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects

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